

0.0.1 Nandamata

nandamātu suttaṃ

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time, the venerable Sariputta and the venerable Mahamoggallāna were wandering on tour with a large community of bhikkhus. Now on that occasion the female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka, having risen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana.

evamme suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ āyasmā ca sārīputta āyasmā ca mahāmoggallāno dakkhiṇāgirisimim cārikaṃ caranti mahatā bhikkhu saṅghena saddhiṃ. tena kho pana samayena velukaṇṭakī nandamātā upāsikā rattiya paccūsasamayaṃ paccūṭṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhāsatī.

2. At that time the great king Vessavana, was travelling from northern region to the southern region on some business. The great king, Vessavana heard the female lay disciple, Nandamata chanting the Parayana. Having heard, he stood waiting for the chanting to finish. Then the female lay disciple, Nandamata having chanted the Parayana, became silent.

tena kho pana samayena vessavaṇo mahārājā uttarāya disāya¹ dakkhiṇaṃ disaṃ gacchati kenaci-

¹uttaradisāya - sīmu. ■

deva karaṇīyena. assosi kho vessavaṇo mahārājā nandamātāya upāsikāya pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhā-santiyā. sutvā kathāpariyosānaṃ āgamayaṃ māno aṭṭhāsi. atha kho nandamātā upāsikā pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhāsitvā tuṇhī ahosi.

3. So then the great king Vessavana having known that the female disciple, Nandamata had finished, greatly rejoiced saying: “Good sister, good sister.”

atha kho vessavaṇo mahārājā nandamātāya upāsikāya kathāpariyosānaṃ viditvā abbhanumodi: sādhu bhagini, sādhu bhaginīti.

4. “But who is this dear?”

ko panesa bhadramukhāti.

5. “I, O sister, am your brother, the great king Vessavana.”

ahaṃ te bhaginī bhātā vessavaṇo mahārājāti.

6. Good dear. Well now, may this dhamma discourse chanted by me be my gift to you as my guest.

sādhu bhadramukha, tena hi yo me ayaṃ dhammapariyāyo bhaṇito, idante hotu ātittheyyanti.

7. Very well sister, may this also be your gift to me as your guest. Tomorrow the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana will come to Velukantaka without having eaten their morning meal. Having served that community of bhikkhus, dedicate the offering to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

sādhū bhaginī, etaṃ ceva me hotu ātithēyyaṃ: sve ca sārīputta moggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso velukaṇṭakaṃ āgamissati. tañca bhikkhusaṅghaṃ parivisitvā mama dakkhiṇaṃ ādi-seyyāsi. evañca me bhavissati ātithēyyanti.

8. Then with the passing of the night, the female lay disciple, Nandamata prepared excellent hard foods and soft foods at her own house. Then the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana, without having eaten their morning meal, arrived at Velukantaka.

atha kho nandamātā upāsikā tassā rattiyā acca-yena sake nivesane paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpesi. atha kho sārīputtamoggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso yena velukaṇṭako tadavasari.

9. So then the female lay disciple, Nandamata addressed a certain man: “Come you good man, having gone to the monastery, announce to the community of bhikkhus: “It is time Bhante, the meal is ready at the house of the

noble lady, Nandamata.””

atha kho nandamātā upāsikā aññataram purisaṃ
 āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ ambho purisa, ārāmaṃ gan-
 tvā bhikkhusaṅghassa kālaṃ ārocehi: "kālo bhante,
 ayyāya nandamātuyā nivesane niṭṭhitaṃ bhatta,
 nti. evaṃ ayye, ti kho so puriso nandamātāya
 upāsikāya paṭissutvā ārāmaṃ gantvā bhikkhusaṅ-
 ghassa kālaṃ ārocesi: "kālo bhante, ayyāya nan-
 damātuyā nivesane niṭṭhitaṃ bhattanti, "

10. Then in the morning, the community of bhikkhus
 headed by Sariputta and Moggallana, having dressed,
 having taken bowl and robe, went to the female lay dis-
 ciple, Nandamata's house. Upon arrival, they sat down
 on a prepared seat.

atha kho sārīputtamoggallānapamukho bhikkhu-
 saṅgho pubbanhasamayaṃ nivāsetvā pattacīva-
 raṃ ādāya yena nandamātuyā upāsikāya nivesa-
 naṃ tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā paṭṭattāsane
 nisīdi.

11. So then the female lay disciple, Nandamata, with
 her own hands, served and satisfied the community of
 bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana with excel-
 lent hard foods and soft foods. Then, when the venerable
 Sariputta had eaten and removed his hand from the bowl,
 the female lay disciple, Nandamata, having taken a cer-

tain lower seat, sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Sariputta said this to the female lay disciple, Nandamata.

atha kho nandamātā upāsikā sārīputtamoggallā-
napamukhaṃ bhikkhusaṅghaṃ paṇītena khāda-
nīyena bhojanīyena sahatvā santappesi sampavā-
resi. atha kho nandamātā upāsikā āyasmantaṃ
sārīputtaṃ bhuttāviṃ onītapattapāṇiṃ ekaman-
taṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho nandamā-
taraṃ upāsikaṃ āyasmā sārīputto etadavoca:

12. “But who, O Nandamata, announced to you of the community of bhikkhus arrival?”

ko pana te nandamāte, bhikkhusaṅghassa abbhā-
gamaṇaṃ ārocesīti.

13. Here I, O Bhante, having arisen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana. Then, O Bhante, the great king Vessavana having known that I had finished, greatly rejoiced saying: “Good sister, good sister.”

idhāhaṃ bhante, rattiyaṃ paccusasamayaṃ paccuṭ-
ṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhāsivā tuṇhī ahoṣiṃ.
atha kho bhante, vessavaṇo mahārājā mama ka-
thāpariyosānaṃ viditvā abbhanumodi “sādhu bha-
ginī, sādhu bhaginī, ti.

14. “But who is this dear?”

ko panesa bhadramukhāti.

15. “I, O sister, am your brother, the great king Vessavana.”

aḥaṃ te bhaginī bhātā vessavaṇo mahārājāti.

16. Good dear. Well now, may this dhamma discourse chanted by me be my gift to you as my guest.

sādhū bhadramukha, tena hi yo me ayaṃ dhammapariyāyo bhaṇito, idante hotu ātitheyanti.

17. Very well sister, may this also be your gift to me as your guest. Tomorrow the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana will come to Velukantaka without having eaten their morning meal. Having served that community of bhikkhus, dedicate the offering to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

sādhū bhaginī, etaṃ ceva me hotu ātitheyyaṃ: sve ca sārīputta moggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso veḷukaṇṭakaṃ āgamissati. tañca bhikkhusaṅghaṃ parivisitvā mama dakkhiṇaṃ ādisseyyāsi. evaṃca me bhavissati ātitheyanti.

18. That is to say, O Bhante, “May the merits of this offering indeed be for the happiness of that great king Vessavana.”

yadidaṃ bhante, dāne puññaṃ hi taṃ² vessava-
ṇassa mahārājassa sukhāya hotuti.

19. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you converse face to face with the great king by the name of Vessavana, the son of the devas who is so powerful, of such great influence.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra
hi nāma vessavaṇena mahārājena evaṃ mahid-
dhikena evaṃ mahesakkhena devaputtena sam-
mukhā sallapissatīti.

20. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante esova³ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

21. Here, O Bhante, my only son named Nanda, dearly and beloved, the king having siezed him on some pretext

²puññaṃ puññaṃ mahīti - machasaṃ, puññaṃ mahaṃ - pts; puññaṃ mahitaṃ -
syā

³eseva - machasaṃ

or another, dragged him away and killed him. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind when the young boy was siezed or while being siezed; when he was bounded or while being bounded; when he was slained or while being slain.

idha me bhante nando nāma⁴ eko puttako piyo manāpo. taṃ rājāno kismiñcideva pakaraṇe okkassa paggayha jīvitā voropesuṃ. tasmim kho panāhaṃ bhante, dārake gahite vā gayhamāne vā baddhe vā vajjhamāne vā hate vā haṭṭamāne vā nābhijānāmi cittassa aññathattanti.

22. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

23. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante esova⁵ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

⁴nandako nāma - sīmu

⁵eseva - machasaṃ

24. Here, O Bhante, when my husband passed away, he arose in a certain womb of a yakkha. He revealed himself to me with just his former self-begotten. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind on account of that.

idha me bhante, sāmiko kālakato assa aññataraṃ yakkhayoniṃ upapanno⁶. so me teneva purimena attabhāvena uddasseti. na kho panāhaṃ bhante, abhijānāmi tato nidānaṃ cittassa aññathattanti.

25. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante esova⁷ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

27. “From the time, O Bhante, that I was brought to my young husband as a young girl, I do not recall trans-

⁶yakkhayoniyam uppanno - simu ■

⁷eseva - machasam ■

gressing against my husband even in thought, let alone in body.”

yatoḥaṃ bhante, sāmikassa daharasseva daharā ānītā, nābhijānāmi sāmikaṃ manasāpi aticaritā, kuto pana kāyenāti.

28. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante esova⁸ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

30. “Since I, O Bhante, declared myself a female lay disciple, I do not recall purposely transgressing any training rules.”

yadāhaṃ bhante, upāsikā paṭidesitā, nābhijānāmi kiñci sikkhāpadaṃ sañcicca vītikkamitāti.

⁸eseva - machasaṃ

31. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamātetī.

32. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante esova⁹ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

33. Here O Bhante, to whatever extent I wish, quite secluded from sense-desires, secluded from unwholesome dhammas, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of seclusion, connected with thinking and pondering, the first jhana. From the subsiding of thinking and pondering, with the internal tranquilization and unification of mind, without thinking and pondering, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of samadhi, the second jhana. With the fading away of happiness, I, dwelling mindful and contemplative, look on with equanimity as I experience pleasure in the body, of which the Noble Ones say: “The equanimous dweller in pleasure is the mindful one,” I enter upon and abide in the third jhana. From the abandoning of [physical] pleasure and pain, from the extinction of former mental pleasure and mental pain, I enter upon and abide in the

⁹eseva - machasaṃ

utter purity of mindfulness and equanimity, without pain, without pleasure, the fourth jhana.

idhāhaṃ bhante, yāvadeva¹⁰ ākaṅkhāmi vivicceva kāmehi vivicca akusalehi dhammehi savitakkaṃ savicāraṃ vicekajāṃ pītisukhaṃ paṭhamāṃ jhānaṃ upasampajja viharāmi. vitakkavicārānaṃ vūpasamā ajjhattaṃ sampasādanaṃ cetaso ekodibhāvaṃ avitakkaṃ avicāraṃ samādhijaṃ¹¹ pītisukhaṃ dutiyaṃ jhānaṃ upasampajja viharāmi. pītiyā ca virāgā upekkhakā ca viharāmi, satā ca sampajānā sukhañca kāyena paṭisaṃvedemi. yaṃ taṃ ariyā ācikkhantī upekkhako satimā sukhavihāriti tatiyaṃ jhanaṃ upasampajja viharāmi. sukkhassa ca pahānā dukkhassa ca pahānā pubbeva somanassadomanassānaṃ atthagamā adukkhaṃ asukhaṃ upekkhāsati pārisuddhiṃ catutthaṃ jhānaṃ upasampajja viharāmi.

34. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamāteti.

35. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

¹⁰yāvade - machasaṃ

¹¹vivekajāṃ machasaṃ

na kho me bhante esova¹² acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

36. Of these five lower fetters declared by the Auspicious One, O Bhante, I do not see any of them that are not abandoned in myself.

yānīmāni bhante, bhagavatā desitāni pañcoram-
bhāgiyāni saññojanāni, nāhaṃ tesaṃ kiñci attani
appahīnaṃ samanupassāmi.

37. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented,
O Nandamata.”

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamāteti.

38. Then the venerable Sariputta having further instructed, aroused, energized and gladdened the female lay disciple, Nandamata with talk on the Dhamma, having risen up from his seat, he departed.

atha kho āyasmā sārīputto nandamātaraṃ upāsi-
kaṃ dhammiyā kathāya sandassetvā samādape-
tvā samuttejetvā sampahaṃsetvā uṭṭhāyāsanā pak-
kāmiti.

¹²eseva - machasaṃ

